CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The central irony of the story is best stated as: 1

(a) a rich man becomes poor
(b) a policeman is a thief
(c) a professional thief is fooled by a cleverer impostor
(d) a book is lost

2. Which of the following supports the claim that Horace is not a hardened criminal? 1

(a) he sells stolen goods daily
(b) he uses violence
(c) he escapes
(d) he steals once a year and politely helps a stranger

3. Which word best describes the author's style? 1

(a) ornate **(b)** archaic
(c) economical and ironic **(d)** angry

4. Which of the following is a valid criticism of Horace's plan? 1

(a) it involved violence
(b) it was too cruel
(c) it was too simple
(d) it assumed no one would appear and ignored the risk of evidence

5. Which of these best explains why Horace lowers his guard? 1

(a) he is rich
(b) he is tired
(c) the woman acts so naturally that he forgets his own illegal presence
(d) he is blind

6. The writer's use of coincidence is that: 1

(a) two thieves choose the same house on the same night
(b) the book is stolen
(c) the owner is a thief
(d) Horace is a policeman

7. Which question invites a critical reading? 1

(a) Who wrote it?
(b) Where was the library?
(c) What colour was the safe?
(d) Is the story's moral about trust or about greed?

8. The author presents Horace with: 1

(a) hatred **(b)** gentle, amused sympathy
(c) harsh contempt **(d)** fear

9. What does the woman's pretence reveal about trust? 1

(a) trust is a sin
(b) trust is always safe
(c) trust is rare
(d) trust can be manufactured by confident acting

10. The antonym of 'gullible' is: 1

(a) simple **(b)** naive **(c)** sceptical **(d)** trusting

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Examine how the writer evokes sympathy for Horace despite his crime. 2

12. Comment on the use of understatement. 2

13. How does the woman's behaviour affect our view of Horace's honesty? 2

14. How is the idea of 'trust' complicated in the story? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss the theme of deception in the story. 3

16. What role does social status play in Horace's belief? 3

17. Why is it important that the woman remains unnamed or sketchy? 3

OR

Assess the author's use of irony at three levels. 3

18. How does the title prepare for the theme? 3

OR

How does the author show the consequences of impulsive trust? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'A Question of Trust' shows that trust must be earned. Discuss critically. 5

OR

To what extent is the woman responsible for Horace's downfall? 5

20. Analyse the story as a study in irony. 5

OR

Write a short story of about 150 words with the title 'Too Good to Be True'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND